many others had committed high treason against the throne. This is the irony behind the operations Gulmarg and Datta Khel.

On 4 November 1947, an imprisoned and humiliated Brig. Ghansara Singh signed a surrender order drafted by Maj. William Brown. Thereafter, Brown exchanged numerous radio messages with Col. Bacon about the military challenges created by the Indian Army's presence in the state. The Burzil Pass was the weakest link on the Astore Road to Gilgit from Harmosh near Kargil. This position was reinforced. In the event of the Indian Army taking this route, guerrilla action would be launched between Astore and Ramghat. More scouts would have to be urgently recruited and trained; they were drawn from the Chitral, Hunza and Ishkoman forces. Contact was made with Gen. Tariq instructing him to secure the Gurez Valley to prevent an Indian force that was coming up the Burzil route. In fact, a year later in November 1948, Brig. Kanhaiya Lal 'Bagga' Atal, Commander of the 77 Para Brigade had taken Kargil and was ready to go up the Astore Road to Gilgit. He had signalled to the Northern Command Headquarters, asking for permission to do so.[19] The permission was never granted. Why?

Pakistan Takes Gilgit

Back in Gilgit on 11 November 1947, Maj. Brown received a cipher message from Col. Bacon in Peshawar informing him that a representative from Pakistan would be arriving on 16 November to relieve Brown of his command. Bacon wanted all the Rajas and Mir's of the Gilgit Agency to be in Gilgit to meet this representative of the Pakistan Government. On 16 November, at exactly 10 AM, a Harvard aircraft of the Royal Pakistan Air Force, flown by Squadron Leader Ahmed, landed in Gilgit and delivered the new Political Agent Mohammad Alam. Alam had been thoroughly briefed by Col. Bacon in Peshawar before flying to Gilgit. Earlier, he was a Sub-collector or *tehsildar* in NWFP. The handover was formalised on 17 November 1947 and the Pakistani flag was slowly run up on the flagstaff, reaching the pole-head on the last bar of 'God Save the King'. Thereafter,